

Miners Blasted In Twinbill

By **MARK LEIBSON**

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TEMPE, Ariz. — The University of Texas at El Paso baseball team no longer worries about trying to defeat the mighty Arizona State Sun Devils. All the Miners want to do is be respectable.

"I don't relish these 21-4 games," said Coach Andy Cohen Saturday afternoon after his Miners dropped the first half of a day-night doubleheader to the defending Western Athletic Conference champions.

"We really played the kind of ball we are capable of playing through the first six innings," added Cohen. "The score was only 8-3 at that time which is respectable.

"I made a mistake when I pulled Dave (Jannusch). He threw the ball pretty good and the reason I pulled him was because I was trying to avoid a rout. But that's exactly what happened. I brought in a couple of relievers who couldn't get anybody out. I should have left Jannusch in."

No matter if the UTEP starter stayed or not, the Miners were still bombarded once again, dropping its WAC record to 0-6 after losing the second game 13-2. ASU stayed within an arms distance of Arizona in the

WAC's Southern Division with a 4-2 record.

"My kids are doing the best they can. Bad plays have just come at crucial times on simple plays," added Cohen.

The Miner coach was referring to a throwing error by shortstop Rusty Kennedy in the sixth inning which ignited a five-run Sun Devil rally and broke up a 3-3 deadlock.

"But you can't blame Kennedy. He's been our standout both on defense and with his bat the past couple of weeks," said Cohen.

It was Kennedy's leadoff homerun in the second inning over the right field fence which started the scoring for both teams. The Sun Devils scored two runs in the bottom of the second.

Three of ASU's five runs in the sixth were unearned due to the Miner error and after Jannusch was pulled in the seventh, the Sun Devils began taking batting practice with the UTEP relievers.

A total of 15 batters marched to the plate in the seventh and by the time Jannusch, Mike Rima and Bob Alsup accumulated three outs, 11 Sun Devils crossed the plate keyed by homers off the bats of Bob Horner and Hubie Brooks and a three-run double by Mike Hildebrand.